

BAINSA HACKATHON 2026

One at a time.

The first accessibility tool for the hearing side of the table.

THE FLIP

Every tool puts the work on the person who can't hear.

They read faster, ask again, and get told “never mind.” Nobody asks the table to change anything. The people talking never find out they lost someone. *We built the tool for the table.*

“I've started just nodding along even when I have no idea what was decided. My boss mentioned something about a new client project last Thursday and I smiled and agreed but I genuinely don't know what I signed up for.”

R/DEAF · 35↑⁵

“DTS - Dinner Table Syndrome. Deaf people in hearing families are too familiar with this, myself included. It's simply too much work to follow along. That's why you feel like you could sleep for a week, we have to work much harder than a hearing person to understand verbal conversations.”

R/DEAF · FAMILY SUNDAY LUNCH THREAD, 36↑⁶

THE NUMBERS

Where they most want to hear is home.

50M

people in the EU report trouble hearing. About **1 in 9**.¹

56% vs 21%

The **family table** is the #1 place they want to hear.
Work: 21%. EuroTrak Italy 2022.²

170 wpm

Caption comprehension collapses above it. Group
speech runs **160–220**.³

4%

of sampled videos caption non-speech sound: the
laugh, the tone.⁴

HARD-OF-HEARING AND LATE-DEAFENED ADULTS · EU27 FIGURE DERIVED FROM THE 59M EUROPE TOTAL · SOURCES ON
THE LAST SLIDE

THE TABLE

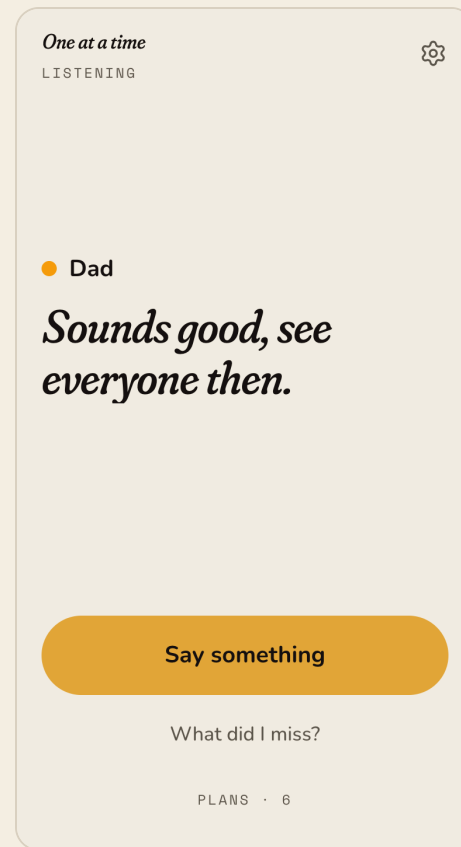
LAMP



their phone

GO AHEAD · ONE AT A TIME

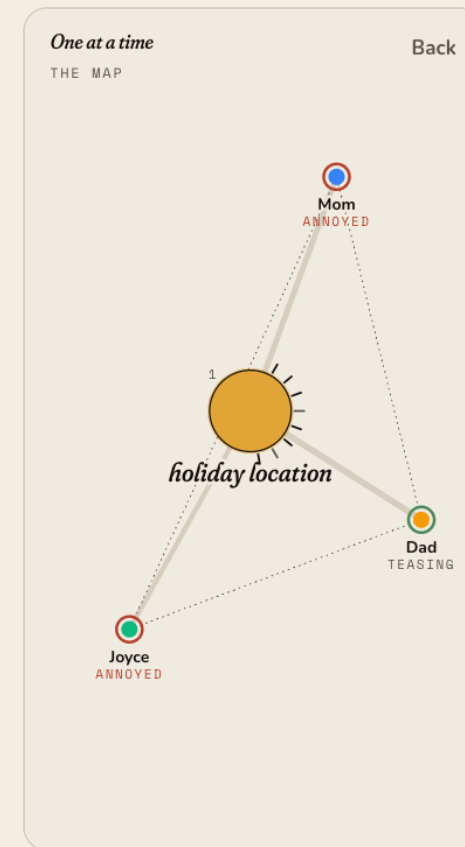
LISTENER



your phone

ONE SENTENCE · NAME · TONE · SAY
SOMETHING

MAP



where it went

WHO, TO WHOM, ABOUT WHAT

WHAT THE LISTENER GETS BACK

What a voice carries, on one screen.

WHO

Every line named. The phones are the mics.

HOW IT WAS SAID

Tone in 0.7 s: *warm, teasing, annoyed.*

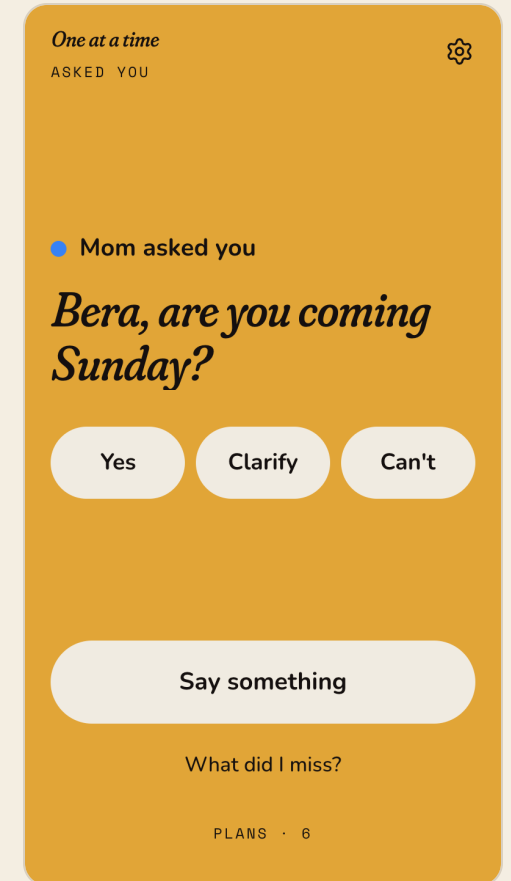
WHAT WAS AGREED

Plans with the reason, refreshed every 10 s.

WHEN THEY LAUGHED

“The table laughed.” No audio model.

● *Your name is called: the whole phone turns amber in under 1 s.*



WHAT'S NEW, HONESTLY

Everyone else builds for the listener.

TOOL	ALREADY DOES	DOESN'T DO
Ava	Phones as named mics, for captions	Never sends pace or overlap back to the speakers' own phones
Otter / Zoom	Summarize the conversation	Only after it's over
Caption glasses	Words in front of the listener's eyes	Put more on the deaf person, nothing the table can act on
One at a time	Phones as mics, like Ava	Amber on the talkers' phones. One sentence, one tap, back to the table.

Ava does the mics. *We do the other side of the table.*

What this is, and isn't.

FOR	Hard-of-hearing and late-deafened adults in hearing rooms.
NOT FOR	Sign-first Deaf users.
TESTED	Not yet tested with a hard-of-hearing user.
REACH	~10M in the EU could use it. Tonight it reaches a table.
LANGUAGES	Italian and Turkish verified, plus English.
NEXT	User tests with hard-of-hearing people. A real voice on the phones (ElevenLabs slot). Look-away catch-up is already built.

SOURCES

1. AEA / EFHOH / EHIMA, *Getting the numbers right on hearing loss in Europe*, 2024. 59M Europe; EU27 ≈50M is our arithmetic.
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2. EHIMA / Anovum, *EuroTrak Italy 2022*, p. 60.
ehima.com/wp-content/uploads/2022/11/EuroTrak_Italy_2022.pdf
3. Caption reading speed vs. conversational pace: synthesis of captioning-speed studies (research/05-numbers-for-pitch.md); not a single primary source.
4. Non-speech information in captions, PMC7040021; May et al., 2025.
pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC7040021/
5. r/deaf, “Anyone else struggling with group conversations at work...” (35↑).
reddit.com/r/deaf/comments/1r2797f/
6. r/deaf, “Exhausted and sad after family Sunday lunch” (36↑).
reddit.com/r/deaf/comments/1fh8h7h/